

HOUSE No. 771

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Tara T. Hong

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act relative to intergenerational community engagement.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>Tara T. Hong</i>	<i>18th Middlesex</i>	<i>1/8/2025</i>
<i>Colleen M. Garry</i>	<i>36th Middlesex</i>	<i>3/9/2025</i>
<i>Samantha Montaño</i>	<i>15th Suffolk</i>	<i>3/5/2025</i>

HOUSE No. 771

By Representative Hong of Lowell, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 771) of Tara T. Hong, Colleen M. Garry and Samantha Montañó relative to intergenerational community engagement. Elder Affairs.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act relative to intergenerational community engagement.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 SECTION 1. Chapter 19A of the General Laws is hereby amended by adding the
2 following section:-

3 Section 45. (a) The department shall establish and administer a statewide community
4 connect program where individuals, including students and working adults, can volunteer to
5 assist seniors with the following:

6 (i) developing technological skills including, but not limited to: using smartphones, video
7 calls or emails;

8 (ii) assisting with daily tasks such as grocery shopping or other errands; and

9 (iii) providing companionship through regular visits or activities.

(b) Subject to appropriation, the department shall establish senior resources centers within senior living facilities and senior community centers. The senior resources centers shall provide the following:

(i) health services, including basic health check-ups, screenings and preventive care resources for seniors;

(ii) counseling, including mental health support, grief counseling and stress management;

(iii) legal aid, including free or low-cost legal advice on wills, housing rights and elder abuse protection; and

(iv) workshops, including information sessions on financial literacy, healthy aging and technology usage.

(c) Students who volunteer for the community connect program shall be eligible for credits towards community service.

(d) The department shall establish and distribute community service awards recognizing individuals who have volunteered for the community connect program.

SECTION 2. This act shall take effect 1 year after its passage.